

CO1 ASSESSMENT TOOL - 2

Name: SHAIK ASHA

Course Code: ITA1416

Reg.no: 192473025

Slot: B

Course Name: ETHICAL HACKING

Debate Topic: Should Ethical Hackers Be Allowed to Hack Systems Without Permission if They Discover Serious Security Flaws?



FOR:

Ethical hackers should be allowed to hack systems without prior permission when they discover serious security flaws because their primary objective is to protect users and prevent cyberattacks. Critical vulnerabilities can expose sensitive personal and financial information, disrupt essential services, and cause significant economic damage if left undiscovered. Independent security researchers often identify weaknesses that organization's internal security teams may overlook, providing an additional layer of protection. Since cybercriminals do not wait for authorization before exploiting vulnerabilities, ethical hackers must sometimes act quickly to minimize potential harm. Through responsible disclosure, they can privately report vulnerabilities to organizations, allowing them to develop security patches before attackers exploit the flaws. In cases involving hospitals, banking systems, or other critical infrastructure, timely intervention can prevent widespread disruption and protect public safety. Ethical hackers act with the intention of strengthening cybersecurity rather than causing damage or stealing information. Their work has contributed significantly to improving the security of many widely used technologies. In exceptional circumstances, the ethical responsibility to protect society may outweigh the requirement for prior authorization, provided the hacker acts responsibly, limits their actions to verifying the vulnerability, and reports it immediately. Therefore, limited, good-faith security testing can be ethically justified when it serves the greater public interest.